1.3 The Proof Stack - Build the Evidence Vault That Makes PDs Say Yes

Elite private strategy - not for redistribution

WAR-ROOM NOTES - 1.3 The Proof Stack

WHY THIRD-PARTY EVIDENCE WINS (THE SOCIAL-PROOF MECHANICS)

A Program Director's yes is a public decision. Every add is logged by the program team, the listeners, and the industry. When the PD says yes to an unknown and the song underperforms, the cost is their credibility - not yours. Third-party evidence transfers the risk away from their judgment: "I'm not guessing. This was already played, already reviewed, already chosen by someone else." That is the only reason an unknown ever gets added. Your Proof Stack is not decoration. It is risk-transfer armor.

THE PROOF-STACK FORMAT HIERARCHY

- Rotation receipts - other stations' spins/logs. Highest power. Earliest adopter wins.
- Industry-adjacent co-signs - known DJs, press, playlist curators, genre institutions.
- Audience numbers - streams, saves, market-specific listeners (a PD cares about their market, not global).
- Live/touring proof - tickets, capacity, city-specific draw.
- Collateral proof - merch numbers, TikTok/fan content, radio-style coverage.

Anything ranked 1-2 can carry a pitch alone. Ranks 3-5 stack.

THE LOCAL-RECEIPT GOLD STANDARD

The receipts that matter most to a local PD are local. A 2,000-stream month in their market with 40 locals following you beats 100,000 global streams. Module 2's heat map exists because of this. When you log receipts, tag them by market. The stack you present to a Boston station is not the stack you present to an Austin station. One master inventory. Market-filtered payloads per target.

THE TRAP: PROOF THAT READS AS DESPERATION

Screenshots of troll comments, a 3-star review, an unpaid feature blog with 11 readers, a "featured artist" badge from a bot program - all of these are anti-proof. If a piece of evidence cannot survive a PD's five-second credibility scan, it goes in the trash, not the stack. Curate like a curator, not a fan.

THE COMPOUNDING THEOREM

Every add you win is a receipt. Every receipt strengthens the next pitch. The system's growth is exponential, not linear - which is why the first four weeks feel slow and the fifth week feels like a flood. Build the vault. Feed it daily. The flood is coming.